Idaho Pregnancy Risk Assessment Tracking System (PRATS)
Methodology
Updated: 8/6/2026

Sampling Frame: PRATS uses birth record data from Idaho Vital Records and Health Statistics to select its annual sample. To create the annual sampling frame for PRATS, birth record data are limited to mothers that meet the following criteria:

1. Mother was 18 years or older at the time of birth
2. Mother was an Idaho resident and gave birth in Idaho
3. Mother and infant(s) are alive at the time of sample selection
4. No surrogacy or adoption occurred

Sample Selection:

PRATS 2023 and Prior
People who gave birth in the previous calendar year were selected for the sample annually in the late spring. Disproportionate stratified sampling was used to randomly select 600 mothers from each of the seven health districts (4,200 mothers total). Survey administration started in the late spring, and data collection typically ended between November or December. Babies ranged in age from 5 months to 22 months when mothers received the survey.

PRATS 2024
Mothers were selected in two waves, with each wave representing six months' worth of births. Survey administration began 2.5 months after the last birth within that wave (e.g., for babies born between the start of July and the end of December, their mothers were surveyed mid-March). For each wave, survey administration lasted 2.5 months. Babies ranged in age from 2.5 months to 11 months when mothers received the survey.

For each survey wave, 2,100 mothers were selected, for a total of 4,200 selected mothers across the two waves. Disproportionate stratified sampling was used to oversample Hispanic mothers. In each wave, 25% of selected mothers were Hispanic, and 75% were non-Hispanic.

PRATS 2025 and Onward
Mothers are selected in three waves, with each wave representing four months' worth of births. Survey administration begins 2.5 months after the last birth within that wave (e.g.,

for babies born between mid-February and mid-June, their mothers are surveyed at the start of September). For each wave, survey administration lasts 2.5 months. Babies range in age from 2.5 months to 9 months when mothers respond to the survey.

Approximately 1,400 mothers are selected in each survey wave, for a total of approximately 4,200 selected mothers across the three waves. Disproportionate stratified sampling is used to oversample Hispanic mothers. In each wave, 25% of selected mothers are Hispanic, and 75% are non-Hispanic.

Survey Administration

PRATS 2019 and Prior

Typically during early summer, mothers who were selected to be part of the annual PRATS sample were contacted via mail. Mothers could complete the survey in one of two ways: (1) by completing a mail-in paper survey packet, or (2) by calling a provided number and completing the survey over the phone. Mothers were provided with both survey completion options in the invitation letter and all proceeding letters. The survey contained approximately 80 questions. The survey and all mailing materials were available in both English and Spanish.

PRATS 2020 to 2022

During early summer, mothers who were selected to be part of the annual PRATS sample were contacted via mail. Mothers could complete the survey in one of three ways: (1) by completing a mail-in paper survey packet; (2) by calling a provided number and completing the survey over the phone; or (3) by completing an online survey. Mothers were provided with all three survey completion options in the invitation letter and all proceeding letters. The survey contained approximately 80 questions. The survey and all mailing materials were available in both English and Spanish.

PRATS 2023 and Onward

Mothers are contacted via mail at various points throughout the year, depending on when they gave birth. Mothers can complete the survey in one of two ways: (1) by completing a mail-in paper survey packet, or (2) by completing an online survey. In the first and second letters, mothers are provided with a QR code to the online survey. Mothers are not provided with a mail-in paper survey packet until the third letter. (This change in methodology has resulted in most mothers completing the survey online.)

The survey contains approximately 60 questions. (For PRATS 2023, the PRATS survey was updated and redesigned to better align with CDC PRAMS. Over 20 questions were removed from the original survey.)

The survey and all mailing materials are available in both English and Spanish.

Survey Weights

PRATS 2016 and Prior

Final survey weights were calculated based on health district and marital status. Each survey year had a total of 14 survey weights, which represented all possible combinations of the seven health districts and two marital statuses.

The formula below was used to calculate the final survey weights:

$$w_i = \frac{N \text{ in Health District } i}{n \text{ in Health District } i}$$

N = Number of (un)married people in the sampling frame

n = Number of (un)married respondents in the sample

PRATS 2017 and Onward

In 2025, survey weights from PRATS 2017 and onward were recalculated. The final updated survey weights comprise of three different weights: (1) design weights; (2) non-response weights; and (3) post-stratification weights.

The following process is used to develop the final survey weights:

1. Design and Non-Response Weights: Using R's `survey` package, an initial survey weight, which accounts for design and nonresponse, is created using the *svydesign()* function.
2. Iterative Proportional Fitting: Using the *rake()* function, post-stratification weights are developed through iterative proportional fitting. (For PRATS 2017 to PRATS 2023, post-stratification weights for Hispanic ethnicity and age were applied. For PRATS 2024 and onward, only post-stratification weights for age were applied since the design and non-response weight already accounted for population margins of Hispanic ethnicity.)
3. Trimming: If there are survey weights greater than two standard deviations from the mean weight value, they are trimmed and redistributed using the trimWeights() function.

Yearly Sample

Survey	Birth Range	Survey Administered
PRATS 2017	January 1, 2017 – December 31, 2017	December 2018 – April 2019
PRATS 2018	January 1, 2018 – December 31, 2018	June 2019 – October 2019
PRATS 2019	January 1, 2019 – December 31, 2019	June 2020 – October 2020
PRATS 2020	January 1, 2020 – December 31, 2020	June 2021 – October 2021
PRATS 2021	January 1, 2021 – December 31, 2021	May 2022 – October 2022
PRATS 2022	January 1, 2022 – December 31, 2022	June 2023 – October 2023
PRATS 2023	January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023	September 2024 – January 2025
PRATS 2024	July 1, 2024 – June 31, 2025	June 2025 – November 2026
PRATS 2025	October 16, 2025 – October 15, 2026	May 2026 – March 2027
PRATS 2026	October 16, 2026 – October 15, 2027	May 2027 – March 2028

* The annual PRATS survey is named according to the birth year(s) being assessed. Specifically, each annual survey is named based on the earliest birth year represented in its sampling frame. For example, PRATS 2024 assessed births that occurred from July 2024 through June 2025.